F. Family note: what we learned about water safety

Dear families,

Our class just finished three water safety lessons. Your child practiced:

- **Water places need a grown-up watching**, even a bathtub or a bucket.
- **Ask first** before going near any water, and wait for an answer.
- **Toys don't keep you safe.** Swim rings, noodles and floaties are toys. A life jacket is safety gear for boats, lakes and rivers.
- **If something is wrong: stop, stay back, and get a grown-up.** Children never go in or reach in to help. Ask your child to show you the help words!

What grown-ups can do, from national health and safety organizations:

- Watch closely and constantly whenever your child is in or near water, including the bathtub. Drowning happens in seconds and is often silent (CDC).
- Floaties, water wings and inflatable toys do not prevent drowning (AAP). Children should always wear a life jacket in, on or near lakes and rivers (AAP).
- A home pool needs a fence at least 4 feet high on all four sides, with a self-closing, self-latching gate (CDC, AAP).
- Swim lessons can help reduce drowning risk, and children who have had lessons still need close, constant supervision (CDC, AAP).
- Learn CPR. CPR skills could save someone's life in the time it takes for paramedics to arrive (CDC).

These lessons did not teach swimming, and they do not make any child safe near water alone. A grown-up watching is what keeps children safe.

Teacher: _____ **Class:** _____

Sources: CDC Preventing Drowning (cdc.gov/drowning/prevention); AAP HealthyChildren.org, Drowning Prevention for Curious Toddlers and Swim Lessons. Checked October 12, 2026. From the WaterWiseKids Kindergarten Water Safety Package, version 1.0, waterwisekids.com/educators/